The IB operates directly under the Prime Minister of Pakistan. Like ISI, it has an effective network of offices down to *Tehsil* level (the lowest unit of administration). After the creation of Pakistan in 1947, the IB was dominated by police officers. However, its complexion started changing after the 1970s when direct officers were inducted to form its own cadre.

The IB could be an ideal federal intelligence agency to tackle terrorism provided it is used for this purpose with full authority and resources at its disposal. The International Crisis Group's recommendations to counter religious extremism and terrorism gave due emphasis to the role of the IB (International Crisis Group, 2009).

(a) Vest significantly greater authority in civilian law enforcement agencies, including access to mobile phone records and other data, without having to obtain approval from the military and the Inter-Services Intelligence Directorate (ISI).
(b) Establish through an act of parliament a clear hierarchy of civilian intelligence agencies, including the Federal Investigation Agency (FIA), the provincial criminal investigation departments and the IB, with the IB as the primary authority in anti-terrorism investigations.

Federal Investigation Agency (FIA)

Assigning a counter-terrorism role to FIA was too challenging as it lacked the strength, spirit and set-ups to handle it. FIA is basically an investigation agency that has very few offices across Pakistan, manned with ill-trained staff, plagued with corruption and headed by police officers on deputation who do not have much interest in it. Somebody floated the ridiculous idea of equating it with the American FBI and got fixated with it. In addition to the 12 sections dealing with different sorts of federal crimes, (FIA website), Special Investigation Group (SIG) was set up with American assistance after the 9/11 attack to help investigate terrorism-related cases (Siddiqui, 2012).

SIG could hardly deliver due to the above reasons (*Geo News*, 2009). FIA personnel were more interested in lucrative postings in immigration than in SIG. Its morale and effectiveness further dwindled when a massive suicide and gun and grenade attack on FIA's regional office in Lahore resulted in the deaths of five persons including FIA officers and injuries to 38 others and total destruction of the office building on 16 October 2009.